BUSINESS PLAN

MountainShares

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Executive Summary

MountainShares is a blockchain-based community rewards and mutual-credit system specifically designed to keep value, voice, and decision-making rooted in Appalachian communities. This innovative system directly addresses persistent challenges such as intergenerational wealth extraction, the undervaluation of community labor, and the "iron cage" of public benefits that often disenfranchises vulnerable populations. MountainShares counters these issues by establishing a closed-loop economy, monetizing invisible labor through Earned MountainShares (EMS), and providing Benefits-Sensitive Accounts (BSA) with safeguards against disqualification from essential services.

Our solution centers on a closed-loop economy, ensuring wealth generated in Appalachia remains within the region, rather than leaking to distant corporations. The Commons app serves as a hyperlocal marketplace and social hub, evolving from a neighbor-to-neighbor barter system to a full-scale local commerce engine. Ms. Egeria Jarvis, our "AI Steward," provides place-bound intelligence, grounded in millions of local records and respecting Appalachian English, ensuring technology serves the community transparently and accountably.

MountainShares primarily targets Appalachian residents, local small businesses, and institutional partners within West Virginia's New River Gorge corridor. Our core users include vulnerable populations reliant on public assistance, who benefit from our specialized protections. The market strategy prioritizes the speed of currency circulation, with a phased growth model aiming for 200,000–400,000 participants and up to 8,000 merchants statewide, including significant engagement from the West Virginia diaspora.

In a landscape dominated by global platforms and traditional financial intermediaries, MountainShares stands out as a counter-geometry to extraction. Our competitive advantage lies in deep community integration, proprietary "intelligence with a ZIP code," and specialized Benefits-Sensitive Safeguards that other platforms ignore. Customers will choose MountainShares because it offers a safe and transparent way to participate in a digital economy while protecting essential public benefits, fostering a covenant with the community to retain local wealth.

Our marketing strategy integrates symbolic, technical, and economic layers, growing through relationship-driven onboarding at community events and through digital outreach via The Commons app. Local partnerships with municipalities and federal agencies are central to our expansion, supported by Community Champions who perform "ground-truthing" and onboarding. Marketing, staffing, and program delivery are sustained by a structured fee revenue allocation, with 30% of all fees supporting operations and another 30% flowing directly into the Treasury Reserve.

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The onboarding process is a staged, relationship-driven approach, beginning with identity verification and a "Red-Team" onboarding phase for conscious testers, particularly emphasizing Benefits-Sensitive onboarding to protect vulnerable users. We convert interest into participation through a two-game gamification strategy, rewarding both daily community actions and long-term civic contribution, which unlocks governance rights. Merchants and institutional partners are integrated through specific tiers that emphasize local control and zero-cost entry, supported by Ms. Jarvis as a guide and Community Champions for peer-to-peer training.

MountainShares and its administering nonprofit, Harmony for Hope (H4H), are anchored at 704 Main Street, Mount Hope, West Virginia, serving as a community hub and technical laboratory. This strategic location ensures community integration and houses the backbone hardware for the ALLIS mesh nodes, rooting "intelligence with a ZIP code" directly in Appalachia. Future growth involves expanding this corridor-scale mesh throughout the New River Gorge region, with physical deployments in gateway hamlets and regional stewardship hubs.

Our technical stack is a "civilizational stack" built on the Arbitrum One mainnet, featuring five core smart contracts for a closed-loop economy and transparent governance. The Commons app serves as the primary human interface, while Ms. Egeria Jarvis orchestrates over 105 containerized services, providing territorial intelligence grounded in a 5.4-million-belief GeoBelief Information Model. Essential hardware includes ALLIS mesh nodes, providing local intelligence and connectivity even during internet outages, demonstrating a counter-geometry to extractive global platforms by rooting value, ensuring fairness, and maintaining place-based accountability.

The system's integrity is further supported by a robust equipment and tools framework, integrating blockchain and mesh infrastructure with high-performance geospatial databases and a containerized AI orchestration environment. Key components include edge compute hardware for local AI inference, FastAPI and Uvicorn for microservice communication, and Ollama as the local LLM runtime. Security is paramount, employing ML-DSA-65 post-quantum cryptography, a "Blood-Brain Barrier" gateway with six simultaneous filters, and a durable audit trail in jarvis-memory:8056 for glassbox accountability.

Success for MountainShares is measured through a multi-layered KPI Specification, focusing on value retention, monetary health, and community participation. Key metrics include currency velocity (targeting ≥1.0 in Year 1), local loop depth (aiming for ≥4 hops by Year 5), and Commons Work Hours Funded (targeting 10,000 hours per month by Year 5). Governance success is tied to "one UEI = one vote" principles, ensuring quorum thresholds are met for proposals. Platform growth targets active organizations and institutional adoption, while system stability is maintained by passing all preflight gates and ensuring high data accuracy.

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MountainShares establishes strong barriers to entry through deep community integration and earned loyalty, where governance "voice" is earned through documented work. Our first-mover advantage, coupled with institutional momentum from strategic partnerships, creates a formidable local ecosystem. Proprietary "Intelligence with a ZIP code," culturally resonant AI, and specialized Benefits-Sensitive Safeguards further differentiate MountainShares from generic platforms. Post-quantum security and epistemic accountability through an auditable "glassbox" architecture ensure long-term resilience and trust.

MountainShares is legally operated under Harmony for Hope, Inc. (H4H), a West Virginia 501(c)(3) nonprofit, ensuring that value and decision-making remain rooted in Appalachian communities. The founder, Carrie Ann Kidd, has contributed 5,308 hours of senior technical labor, valued at $796,200, establishing non-dilutable governance standing to prevent extractive external capital. This nonprofit/DAO hybrid structure ensures community governance, non-extractive wealth building, and protection for vulnerable residents.

The management team is led by Carrie Ann Kidd, the primary architect, who brings over 10 years of senior geospatial systems architecture experience and deep Appalachian grounding, with her background directly informing the system's "Benefits-Sensitive" protocols. Key operations are supported by Community Champions like Crystal Colyer, Lead Validator, and the Harmony for Hope nonprofit board. As MountainShares scales, future staffing will include Regional Champions, Regulatory and Legal Specialists, Geospatial and AI Engineers, Logistics Coordinators, and Benefits Counselors.

MountainShares benefits from a Scheduled Red Team and a network of technical and community advisors, including Dr. Anurag Srivastava from WVU, Taryn Mosser (State of West Virginia GIS Coordinator), Crystal Coyler (Community Coordinator & Lead Validator), and Brandon Thompson (Starry Eyes Media). These advisors provide rigorous testing and guidance, ensuring the system remains accountable, secure, and aligned with the lived realities of Appalachian West Virginia, with all findings durably logged in jarvis-memory:8056 for transparent auditability.

Should MountainShares secure loans or significant investments, funds will be strategically allocated to physical infrastructure, particularly for ALLIS mesh nodes, with a hardware cost ceiling of $40,000 for a full heritage reference implementation cluster. Regulatory and legal infrastructure, including Money Transmitter License fees and compliance costs, are crucial for statewide commerce. Funds will also support future staffing needs as the system transitions to a regional team, ensuring that decision-making power remains with the community and enabling the monetization of "invisible" labor and local wealth retention. The founder's $796,200 in-kind technical labor significantly enhances grant readiness.

MountainShares utilizes a hybrid funding model, beginning with a substantial in-kind founder investment

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of $796,200, which serves as non-dilutable equity and a critical grant match. We actively seek targeted federal and foundation grants from organizations like the Appalachian Regional Commission and USDA Rural Development, primarily for hardware procurement. As the system transitions to live use, a self-sustaining closed-loop fee engine will generate revenue from transaction fees, with 30% allocated to Harmony for Hope Operations and 30% to the Treasury Reserve. The West Virginia diaspora also represents a significant future funding source through an "Appalachian Premium" on authentic goods, ensuring all generated value remains rooted in the Appalachian commons.

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Opportunity

Problem Worth Solving

Problems Worth Solving

MountainShares addresses several systemic challenges that have historically marginalized Appalachian communities and hindered local wealth retention. Our system is uniquely designed to solve the following critical problems:

1. Intergenerational Wealth Extraction and "Leakage"

For generations, the wealth produced in Central Appalachia—from coal and timber to natural gas—has left the region while the people remained, a process known as **extractive leakage**. Modern **maximopolies** (financial giants like BlackRock) and **megaopolies** (logistics platforms like Amazon) continue this trend by capturing local markets and extracting data, attention, and fees without reinvesting in the community. **MountainShares** solves this by creating a **closed-loop economy** and a permanent **500% reserve floor** to ensure that value produced within the mountains stays in the mountains.

2. The Invisibility of Community Labor

Traditional markets systematically undervalue or ignore essential work such as caregiving, mutual aid, cultural preservation, and education. This results in a **reciprocity deficit** where those building the community's social fabric receive no economic recognition. Through **Earned MountainShares (EMS)**, the system monetizes this "invisible" labor, treating acts of care and learning as currency-generating economic acts rather than unpaid preparation for future employment.

3. The "Iron Cage" of Public Benefits

Many West Virginians rely on means-tested assistance (SSI, SNAP, Medicaid) and live within an "**iron cage**" where participating in the formal economy or earning rewards can disqualify them from essential services. Most digital platforms ignore these complex benefit rules, putting users at risk. **Benefits-Sensitive Accounts (BSA)** provide specialized "fail-safe" protections, including balance caps and earning throttles, designed to ensure that community participation does not trigger a loss of survival benefits.

4. Marginalization by Opaque and "Placeless" AI

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Global AI systems are typically "**placeless**" black boxes that misinterpret Appalachian dialect, culture, and geographic needs. These models often treat authentic community voices as errors to be "corrected." **Ms. Egeria Jarvis** acts as an AI steward with a "**ZIP code**," grounding all reasoning in 5.4 million verified local records (GBIM) and respecting **Appalachian English** as normative rather than erroneous.

5. Rural Data Decay and Connectivity Gaps

Appalachian communities frequently face "**connectivity deserts**" where residents and visitors cannot access critical trail maps, safety information, or resource directories. Furthermore, rural data (such as business hours or clinic locations) decays rapidly, leading to outdated information in global databases. The **ALLIS mesh nodes** provide locally-hosted intelligence that works without internet, while **Community Champions** perform "ground-truthing" to ensure local resource data is verified and accurate.

6. Disenfranchisement in Local Governance

Residents often feel they have "**no say**" in the infrastructures that govern their economic and informational lives. In traditional systems, power is bought with financial stake, leaving the most vulnerable without a voice. MountainShares implements a **"one-UEI-one-vote"** principle where governance standing is earned through documented hours of contribution, ensuring that those who do the work are the ones who steer the commons.

Our Solution

MountainShares addresses the systemic extraction of wealth and power from Appalachian communities by providing a **community-governed economic stack** designed to keep value, voice, and decision-making rooted in place.

1. A Closed-Loop Economy to Stop "Leakage"

For generations, the wealth produced in Appalachia—from coal to timber—has "leaked" out of the region to distant owners. MountainShares solves this by creating a **closed-loop economy** where value stays and recirculates locally.

- **Purchased MountainShares (PMS):** Residents load U.S. dollars into a digital wallet to spend at **local businesses**.
- **Earned MountainShares (EMS):** Residents earn rewards for **community work** like caregiving, teaching, or heritage preservation.

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- **Internal Buying Power:** As the community treasury grows, the value of these rewards increases through **three distinct phases**. Eventually, $1.00 of community value can stretch to $34.70 in local buying power, a rate pegged to the federal volunteer valuation.

2. The Commons: A Digital Town Square

The "Commons" app is the primary human interface for this system—a **hyperlocal marketplace** and social hub.

- **Barter and Discovery:** In its early stages, the app functions like a "neighbor-to-neighbor" board for trading help and resources.
- **Full Local Commerce:** As it matures, it evolves into an Amazon-style marketplace, but one where the **merchants are your neighbors**, and the transaction fees stay in a community treasury rather than flowing to global corporations.

3. Ms. Jarvis: Intelligence with a ZIP Code

Traditional AI is "placeless," often misinterpreting local needs or Appalachian dialect. **Ms. Egeria Jarvis** is a transparent "AI Steward" designed specifically for West Virginia.

- **Grounded in Reality:** Ms. Jarvis is anchored to millions of real local records—including **land ownership, infrastructure, and hazards**—so her advice is always tied to a physical address or "ZIP code".
- **Respecting the Voice:** The system is calibrated to recognize **Appalachian English** as normative rather than "incorrect," ensuring it communicates with residents as a respectful neighbor.

4. Protecting Those on Public Benefits

A major barrier to economic participation in Appalachia is the **"Iron Cage" of public benefits**. Many residents fear that earning rewards will disqualify them from essential assistance like **SNAP, Medicaid, or SSI**.

- **Benefits-Sensitive Accounts (BSA):** MountainShares includes specialized "fail-safe" protections. For these accounts, the system enforces **balance caps and earning throttles** to ensure participation doesn't accidentally trigger a loss of benefits.

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- **Community Standing:** The system treats earned rewards as a record of **community contribution** (a "time bank" model) rather than countable cash income, providing a stronger legal argument for protecting participants' eligibility.

5. Voice Earned Through Work, Not Wealth

In most systems, money buys influence. In MountainShares, **governance power is earned through contribution**.

- **One-UEI-One-Vote:** Every verified human (Unique Ecosystem Identifier) gets one equal vote in community decisions.
- **Rank Progression:** By logging hours of community labor, residents move through ranks—from **Bronze to Elder**. Higher ranks unlock the ability to propose new rules or help steward the community's resources, ensuring that those who do the work are the ones who steer the ship.

Target Market

Target Market

MountainShares defines its ideal customer base as a multi-layered ecosystem of Appalachian residents, small businesses, and institutional partners. We primarily focus on West Virginia's New River Gorge corridor. Our target market strategy aims to reverse the "geometry of extraction" that has historically removed wealth from the region.

Core Users and Segments

MountainShares serves three primary segments:

- **Individual Residents and Families:** This segment includes vulnerable populations such as the elderly, disabled, medically underserved, and unemployed. A critical sub-segment is Benefits-Sensitive Account (BSA) holders who receive means-tested assistance (SSI, SNAP, Medicaid). These individuals require special protections to participate in the digital economy without risking their essential benefits.
- **Local Small Businesses (Merchants):** These are the "economic anchors" that seek to increase the speed at which money circulates within the local economy and prevent value from being lost to large global platform monopolies.

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- **Community and Institutional Partners:** This includes nonprofits, churches, and mutual-aid groups, as well as "Commons Node Operators" like universities (e.g., WVU) and public agencies (e.g., National Park Service) who host data and support regional resilience.

Shared Characteristics and Expectations

The MountainShares community is characterized by:

- **Deep Rootedness:** Participants are often embedded in long-standing traditions of mutual aid and "hollow-to-hollow" care.
- **Sophisticated Distrust:** Residents have valid, earned reasons to distrust distant corporate and technocratic institutions. Consequently, they expect "glassbox" transparency and auditable evidence rather than blind trust.
- **Invisible Laborers:** Many core users perform essential but unmonetized work, such as informal caregiving. The economic value of this work is recognized through Earned MountainShares (EMS).

Market Size and Growth Opportunity

MountainShares follows a phased growth model that prioritizes the speed of currency circulation over simply increasing user counts:

- **Phase 0 (Pilot):** Anchored in Fayette County targeting 25–100 invite-only participants and 5–15 local merchants.
- **Phase 1 (County Scale):** Targets 500–2,000 active participants and 30–75 merchants in Fayette County.
- **Phase 2 (Regional Corridor):** Expands to 15,000–40,000 participants and 300–800 merchants across the New River Gorge and southern West Virginia.
- **Phase 3 (Statewide and Diaspora):** Aims for 200,000–400,000 participants and up to 8,000 merchants. A significant portion of this market is the West Virginia diaspora—an estimated 200,000+ out-migrants who can support the community treasury via a USD storefront.

The system identifies a "threshold of sufficiency" at approximately 315,800 participants (statically equivalent to 0.01% of Mastercard's global base) to sustainably back a 500% reserve-backed community economy at Phase 3 levels.

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Competition

In the current landscape of Central Appalachia, MountainShares does not face a single direct competitor offering an identical blockchain-based mutual-credit system. Instead, it competes against a **geometry of extraction** composed of global platforms, traditional financial intermediaries, and informal local alternatives.

1. The Competition and Alternatives

Global Platform Megaopolies (Amazon, Meta, TikTok) Today, residents rely on these giants for logistics, retail, and community discourse. While efficient, these systems treat Appalachian towns as interchangeable nodes in a fulfillment network, extracting fees, attention, and behavioral data without local reinvestment.

Passive Ownership Maximopolies (BlackRock, Vanguard) These financial giants control capital flows and abstract claims on the region's land, utilities, and energy projects. They prioritize global portfolio performance over long-term local stability, often turning West Virginia assets into abstract line items in distant dashboards.

Traditional Digital Payment Apps (PayPal, Venmo, USDC) While these apps allow for easy money transfer, they lack community-rooted rewards or structural safeguards. Furthermore, they offer high transaction visibility to distant centers with few protections for **Benefits-Sensitive Account** holders who risk losing essential assistance like SSI or SNAP if their digital balances are treated as countable resources.

Informal Bartering and Historical Scrip Appalachian communities have deep traditions of informal mutual aid and "hollow-to-hollow" care. Historically, "company scrip" provided a form of local credit but was used as an instrument of control. While informal networks are resilient, they often lack the analytical tools to measure extraction or scale local wealth.

2. The MountainShares Advantage

MountainShares is the best choice for Appalachian communities because it is built as a **counter-geometry** designed to keep value, voice, and decision-making rooted in place.

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- **Place-Bound Intelligence with a "ZIP Code":** Unlike generic AI assistants, the Ms. Jarvis steward system is anchored in 5.4 million verified local beliefs and 45GB of PostGIS spatial data specific to West Virginia. This ensures the system respects local geography and **Appalachian English morphosyntax** as normative rather than erroneous.
- **Monetizing "Invisible" Labor via Mutual Credit:** Traditional loyalty programs reward spending; MountainShares rewards **contribution**. Through **Earned MountainShares (EMS)**, the system monetizes caregiving, mutual aid, and cultural preservation—labor that global markets value at zero.
- **The 500% Reserve Floor:** Most community currencies are vulnerable to economic shocks. MountainShares implements a permanent **500% Reserve Floor** in Phase 3—5.00inliquidbackingforevery1M in circulation—acting as a "lock on the door" to ensure the commons stays resilient against volatility and extraction.
- **Glassbox Accountability vs. Black-Box AI:** Competitors hide their decision-making logic. MountainShares uses a **"glassbox" architecture** where every decision is cryptographically signed using **ML-DSA-65 post-quantum algorithms** and written to a durable audit trail at `jarvis-memory:8056`. This allows the community to audit *why* the system made a particular choice.
- **Democratic "One-UEI-One-Vote" Governance:** In this system, power is not bought with financial stake. Governance rights are earned through **documented hours of work**, ensuring that the people who build the commons are the ones who steer it.

3. Why Customers Will Choose Us

Customers will choose MountainShares because it solves the **"Iron Cage" of public benefits** that other platforms ignore. By offering specialized protections for means-tested assistance recipients, MountainShares makes it safe for the most vulnerable West Virginians to participate in a digital economy without risking their survival. It is not just an app; it is a **covenant** with the community to ensure that wealth produced in the mountains stays in the mountains.

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Execution

Marketing Plan

MountainShares attracts and connects with its audience by integrating its symbolic, technical, and economic layers into a "civilizational stack" that prioritizes local trust and wealth retention. The program is designed to grow deliberately, evolving through a relationship-driven onboarding process rather than mass solicitation.

Main Ways to Reach the Audience

- **Community Events and Physical Discovery:** Outreach begins at the "ground-truth" level. **Physical heritage infrastructure**, such as QR code markers on the **Mount Hope Historic Walking Trail**, serves as tangible entry points where residents connect to digital economic participation. The system also utilizes **ALLIS mesh nodes**, which provide connectivity and safety information in "connectivity deserts," acting as on-site discovery hubs for the program. Seasonal campaigns like "Harvest Heritage Week" or "Spring Trail Mapping Drives" further embed the system into local community rhythms.
- **Digital Outreach:** The central interface is **The Commons Marketplace App**, which evolves from a neighbor-to-neighbor barter board to a full-scale local commerce engine. A specialized **USD Storefront** targets the **200,000+ West Virginia diaspora**, allowing out-migrants to support their home communities by purchasing authentic WV-made goods, which directly strengthens the local treasury.
- **Local Partnerships:** MountainShares establishes **Corridor Partner Community Governance Agreements** with municipalities, nonprofits, and federal agencies (like the National Park Service in Thurmond) to host mesh nodes at no direct financial cost to the partner. It also relies on **Community Champions**—trusted local residents who perform "ground-truthing" to verify local data and serve as the primary onboarding force.
- **Educational Content: Ms. Jarvis** serves as a "glassbox" AI steward and narrator, explaining rules, rewards, and safety triggers in "plain, warm language". Specialized **"Plain Language Notices"** are provided for **Benefits-Sensitive Accounts (BSA)** to educate participants on how to earn rewards without risking essential public assistance. Furthermore, the **"Ms. Jarvis Curriculum"** provides a transferable body of knowledge for other communities interested in building accountable AI.

Funding the Marketing Efforts

Marketing, staffing, and program delivery are sustained through a structured **fee revenue allocation**.

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- **30% of all fees** are allocated to **Harmony for Hope Operations** for administration and outreach.
- **25% of fees** are split between **Community Programs (15%) and Community Projects (10%)**, specifically to fund local events, education, and mutual-aid initiatives.
- The **Founder's Technical Investment ($796,200)** serves as a documented in-kind match for federal and foundation grants, significantly increasing the system's "grant readiness" to fund regional expansion.

The Core Message and Pitch

The MountainShares pitch focuses on **non-extractive wealth building** and **spatial justice**. The core message is summarized by taglines such as **"Like scrip, but fair," "Earn where you live,"** and **"Intelligence with a ZIP code"**.

Unlike traditional platforms that extract data and value, MountainShares unique value proposition includes:

- **Accountability to Place:** Power and decision-making are rooted in local communities rather than distant corporate headquarters.
- **Recognition of Invisible Labor:** The system monetizes community-building work (like caregiving and mutual aid) that traditional markets ignore.
- **Economic Resilience:** A **500% reserve floor** protects the community from the volatility of extractive industries and global financial shocks.
- **Safety for the Vulnerable:** Specialized protections ensure the most vulnerable residents can participate in the digital economy without losing their public benefits.

Sales Plan

MountainShares utilizes a staged, relationship-driven "sales" process designed to move Appalachian residents and institutions from awareness to active stewardship. This process is anchored in the "staged protocol" of the Appalachian field experiments and supported by a multi-layered gamification strategy.

1. The Onboarding Process: Identity and Enrollment

Onboarding is managed through a two-layer identity geometry that ensures privacy while maintaining

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community integrity.

- **Step 1: Identity Recognition.** Potential participants are issued a private, immutable **Wallet ID** and a governable public **UUID**. This process includes identity verification (KYC) appropriate to the user's risk tier and role.
- **Step 2: Staged Rollout.** Onboarding is not a mass enrollment but follows a deliberate sequence. It begins with **Stage 1 "Red-Team" Onboarding**, where researchers, partners, and merchants are brought in as "conscious testers" to identify failure modes before the system opens to the wider public.
- **Step 3: Benefits-Sensitive Onboarding.** For the significant portion of the population on public assistance, onboarding includes an explicit "Benefits-Sensitive" designation. This removes the primary barrier to adoption—fear of losing essential benefits—by implementing hard balance caps and earning throttles.

2. Community Engagement: The Two-Game Strategy

MountainShares converts interest into ongoing participation through a sophisticated gamification engine that rewards daily life and long-term civic contribution.

- **The Daily Life Game (The Commons):** This layer provides immediate rewards for concrete community actions. Participants engage through **Quests** (e.g., scanning trail markers, attending workshops, fulfilled help requests) and **Streaks** (e.g., daily contribution). Completion of these activities generates **Earned MountainShares (EMS)**.
- **The Contribution Game (MountainShares):** Daily activities stack into a longitudinal "Long Game." Participants advance through **Ranks** (Bronze, Silver, Gold, Champion, Elder) and earn **Visual Badges** (e.g., "Founding Legacy," "Knowledge Keeper") based exclusively on documented hours of work. This progression directly unlocks governance rights and increased earning ceilings.

3. Partner Integration: Merchants and Institutional Nodes

Local businesses and public agencies are integrated through specific partnership tiers that emphasize local control and zero-cost entry.

- **Merchants:** Local businesses are "sold" on the system's ability to drive **local economic circulation** and reduce "value leakage" to global platforms. They are onboarded into the Stage 3 "Full Commerce" layer, where they can accept M$ for goods and services.

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- **Corridor Partners:** Agencies like the National Park Service or municipal governments join via the **Corridor Partner Community Governance Agreement**. This agreement allows them to host mesh intelligence nodes (ALLIS) at no direct financial cost, sponsored by the MountainShares tier, provided they contribute site access and heritage content.

4. Support and Education: The Steward and the Champions

Technical and social support is decentralized through a mix of AI and human stewardship.

- **Ms. Jarvis as Guide:** The AI steward acts as the primary narrator for the system, surfacing available quests, notifying users of badge achievements in plain language, and explaining how activities translate to rewards.
- **Community Champions:** These are local residents and frontline practitioners who serve as a structured "red team." They act as the primary human onboarding force, "ground-truthing" data and providing peer-to-peer training on how to use the system safely and effectively.
- **Resource Education:** Explicit resources, such as the **Benefits-Sensitive Account Plain Language Notice**, are provided to help users navigate complex intersections between the community economy and public programs.

Locations & Facilities

MountainShares and its administering nonprofit, Harmony for Hope (H4H), are physically anchored at 704 Main Street, Mount Hope, West Virginia 25880. This location is not merely an administrative office; it serves as a community hub for arts, youth programming, and technical stewardship, positioning the project directly within the Appalachian community it serves.

Strategic Significance of the Mount Hope Location

The choice of a downtown building in Mount Hope is a deliberate geographic act. Though described as "structurally compromised yet centrally located," the building provides a vital "laboratory world" for studying the flows of capital, attention, and control in Appalachia.

Community Integration: The office is situated on a working main street in a "Phoenix City" that rebuilt itself after a historic fire, symbolizing the resilience the program aims to support.

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It is surrounded by key local institutions, including the Fayette County Community Arts Center and the trailhead for the Mount Hope Historic Walking Trail.

Technical Infrastructure: The building houses the backbone hardware for the first reference implementation of the ALLIS mesh intelligence nodes. By hosting servers and AI orchestration on-site in West Virginia, MountainShares ensures that "intelligence is given a ZIP code" and power remains accountable to place rather than residing in a distant corporate cloud.

Operational Grounding: Working from this location allows the lead architect to remain embedded in the "Tacet"—the lived experience and non-negotiable evidence of Appalachian life—ensuring the system is built with a genuine understanding of local needs.

Future Growth and Physical Expansion

The plan for MountainShares' physical footprint is to move from a single anchor to a corridor-scale mesh throughout the New River Gorge region:

Node Clusters: Physical deployments are planned for "gateway hamlets" such as Thurmond, where an ALLIS node will provide interpretive and safety data in a connectivity desert.

Regional Stewardship Hubs: The long-term vision involves a federated network of local steward hubs anchored in regional colleges, libraries, clinics, and trusted community organizations across multiple Appalachian counties.

Timeline: While core framework deliverables are ongoing, the hardware procurement and completion of the full heritage node clusters are targeted for October 2027, with final project hand off scheduled for November 2028.

Technology

MountainShares utilizes a multi-layered technical stack designed to ensure economic sovereignty, data integrity, and place-anchored accountability for Appalachian communities. The technology is categorized into a "civilizational stack" that integrates decentralized ledgers, community-facing applications, and resilient physical infrastructure.

1. Key Software Systems

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The software backbone of MountainShares is built to manage a closed-loop economy and a transparent governance model:

- **Blockchain Infrastructure:** The system is deployed on the **Arbitrum One mainnet** (Chain ID 42161), a Layer 2 Ethereum rollup selected for its balance of high security and low transaction costs for rural users. Five core smart contracts— `phase_mgmt`, `central_cmd`, `ms_token`, `backbone`, and `volunteer_hrs` —govern the issuance of tokens, treasury management, and participation rules.
- **The Commons Marketplace App:** This is the primary human interface, evolving through three stages: from a neighbor-to-neighbor marketplace to a full-scale commerce engine. It integrates social features, real-time rewards tracking, and governance tools, allowing members to participate in decision-making and discover community events.
- **Ms. Egeria Jarvis (AI Steward):** Ms. Jarvis is a "glassbox" AI architecture that orchestrates over **105 containerized services** to provide territorial intelligence. She monitors treasury health, enforces constitutional safety triggers, and provides "intelligence with a ZIP code" grounded in a **5.4-million-belief GeoBelief Information Model (GBIM)**.
- **Decentralized Memory:** The system uses **IPFS (Kubo)** for distributed storage of participation records and rewards tracking, ensuring that economic memory persists even if centralized servers fail.

2. Essential Hardware and IT Infrastructure

MountainShares is designed to operate on community-owned hardware, prioritizing resilience in rural contexts:

- **ALLIS Mesh Nodes:** The **Artificial Learning & Location Intelligence System (ALLIS)** consists of locally-hosted mesh nodes (`MS.___.ALLIS`) that function as "local brains". These nodes provide maps, safety data, and AI-assisted support on-site, remaining operational even during internet outages or in "connectivity deserts" like the New River Gorge corridor.
- **Edge Compute and Connectivity:** Hardware procurement includes **Prism units and SKLink wireless infrastructure** for point-to-point mesh connectivity. The system currently runs on a high-performance consumer host (Lenovo Legion 5) located directly in **Mount Hope, West Virginia**, demonstrating that sophisticated AI can run on community-scale hardware.
- **Heritage Infrastructure:** Physical markers, such as **QR codes** along the Mount Hope Historic Walking Trail, serve as tangible entry points where residents connect to locally hosted historical content via the mesh.

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3. Technology in Service of the Mission

This technical architecture is a deliberate "counter-geometry" to extractive global platforms:

- **Rooting Value:** By using **closed-loop wallets** and locally-hosted ALLIS nodes, the system ensures that wealth and data stay within Appalachian communities rather than leaking to distant corporations.
- **Fairness and Transparency:** Every decision made by the system is cryptographically signed using **ML-DSA-65 post-quantum algorithms** and written to a durable, authenticated audit trail in `jarvis-memory:8056`. This allows communities to independently verify why the system made a particular choice.
- **Place-Based Accountability:** Unlike generic AI, Ms. Jarvis's reasoning is grounded in authentic **Appalachian English (AAPCAppE)** and PostGIS spatial data, ensuring she respects local culture and geographic realities.

Equipment & Tools

MountainShares operates on a multi-layered technical stack that integrates decentralized blockchain ledgering, high-performance geospatial databases, and a containerized AI orchestration environment. This "civilizational stack" ensures that community data and value are managed with the rigor of a global financial system but remain anchored to Appalachian geography.

1. Blockchain and Mesh Infrastructure

The economic backbone of the system is deployed on the **Arbitrum One mainnet** (Chain ID 42161), a Layer 2 Ethereum rollup selected for its balance of high security and low transaction costs for rural users. The system utilizes five core smart contracts: `phase_mgmt`, `central_cmd`, `ms_token`, `backbone`, and `volunteer_hrs`.

Physical connectivity and on-site intelligence are provided by **ALLIS mesh nodes** (`MS.___.ALLIS`). These nodes function as "local brains," storing maps, heritage content, and safety data locally to remain operational even during internet outages. Hardware procurement for these clusters includes:

- **Primary Intelligence Nodes:** Edge compute hardware capable of local AI inference.
- **Network Infrastructure:** Point-to-point mesh wireless and **SKLink** hardware.

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- **Heritage Kiosks:** Weatherproof, vandal-resistant outdoor displays for trailhead interaction.

2. Software Development and AI Orchestration

The system is built on a massive codebase of over **51,000 Python modules** across 175 services. Core components are managed through a **Docker Compose** mesh of approximately **105 active containers**. Key software tools include:

- **Frameworks: FastAPI** and **Uvicorn** for microservice communication.
- **AI Engine: Ollama** serves as the local LLM runtime, managing a 22-model ensemble for consensus-based reasoning.
- **Orchestration: Redis** (port 6380) manages asynchronous job states and health caching.

3. Security and Privacy Systems

To protect against extraction and cyber threats, MountainShares employs a **"glassbox" security architecture**:

- **Post-Quantum Cryptography:** The system uses **ML-DSA-65** (Module Lattice Digital Signature Algorithm) to sign judge verdicts, ensuring signatures are tamper-evident even against future quantum computing.
- **Blood-Brain Barrier (BBB):** A specialized gateway (port 8016) that enforces six simultaneous filters —Ethical, Spiritual, Safety, Threat Detection, Steganography, and Truth Verification—on every request.
- **Perimeter Security:** A **Caddy reverse proxy** (port 8443) manages a Cloudflare tunnel and enforces role-based access control via `jarvis-auth:8055`.
- **Durable Audit:** All decisions are logged to `jarvis-memory:8056`, a secured store that persists across container restarts for community accountability.

4. Data Management and Memory

MountainShares utilizes a three-database PostgreSQL architecture combined with decentralized storage:

- **PostgreSQL/PostGIS:** Two primary instances— `msjarvis` for the **5.4M-belief GBIM layer** (port 5433) and `msjarvisgis` for **45 GB of PostGIS spatial data** (port 5432).

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- **ChromaDB:** A vector database (port 8002) managing **47+ active collections** and **6.7M+ embeddings** for semantic memory and RAG retrieval.
- **IPFS (Kubo):** Content-addressable storage (port 5001) used for permanent, distributed rewards tracking and participation records.

5. Future Technology Investments

A formal hardware procurement framework is established for the **MS.MHHWT.ALLIS Heritage Reference Implementation Cluster**. The project has set a hardware **cost ceiling of $40,000** for extended corridor-ready deployments, which includes pre-positioned infrastructure for expanding the mesh. Major procurement milestones are aligned for **October 2027**, contingent on grant funding from sources like USDA Rural Development or the Appalachian Regional Commission.

Milestones

No milestones yet.

Key Metrics

MountainShares defines success through a rigorous, multi-layered **KPI Specification** that measures economic health, community participation, and structural impact within Appalachian communities. By tracking these actual results, the system remains accountable to its mission of retaining local value and preventing extraction.

1. Value Retention and Monetary Health

MountainShares prioritizes **circulation velocity** over raw user counts, operating on the principle that 50 deeply transacting members are more valuable to treasury health than 5,000 passive users.

- **Currency Velocity:** Measures how often a unit of Mchangeshandsmonthly,withaYear1targetof**\ge1.0**andalong−termtargetof**\ge$ 2.0**.
- **Local Loop Depth:** Tracks the median number of "hops" a unit of Mmakeswithinthecommunitybeforebeingconvertedtofiatorleavingtheregion,aimingfor**\ge$ 4 hops** by Year 5.

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- **Circulation Concentration:** Ensures the economy is broadly shared by monitoring the percentage of value held by the top 10 accounts, targeting ≤ **25%** as the network matures.

2. Community Engagement and Usefulness

Success is also measured by how effectively the system monetizes "invisible" community labor that traditional markets ignore.

- **Commons Work Hours Funded:** Tracks total verified hours of caregiving, education, and mutual aid compensated in M$, with a target of **10,000 hours per month** by Year 5.
- **Value Interactions:** Measures high-value actions such as fulfilled help requests, skill sessions, and data validations, targeting **15,000 interactions monthly**.
- **Retention of Core Contributors:** Measures the percentage of users who contribute ≥ 5 verified hours and remain active six months later, aiming for a **65% retention rate**.

3. Decision-Making Participation

Success in governance is tied to the **"one UEI** = **one vote"** principle, ensuring influence is earned through contribution rather than financial stake.

- **Quorum Thresholds:** Key economic and constitutional proposals require a **30% to 40% quorum** of eligible voters to be valid.
- **Participation Weight (PW):** In Phase 3, success is measured by the distribution of PW scores, which determine community dividends based on **Verified Months Active** and an **Activity Multiplier** (up to 2.0x for "Founding Deep" members).

4. Platform Growth and Institutional Adoption

The roadmap for success includes expanding from hyperlocal pilots to statewide regional corridors.

- **Active Organizations and Merchants:** Targets a growth from ≥ 25 active organizations in Year 1 to ≥ **150** by Year 5.
- **Institutional Adoption Milestones:** Tracks formal agreements (MOUs) with municipalities, hospitals, and universities, aiming for ≥ **10 anchor organizations**.
- **New User Activation:** Evaluates onboarding effectiveness by tracking the percentage of new signups that complete their first quest and transaction within 14 days, targeting **60%**.

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5. System Stability and Data Stewardship

MountainShares uses a **"glassbox" audit architecture** to prove it is healthy and aligned with community values.

- **System Integrity:** Success is defined by maintaining **105+ running containers** with **zero public exposures** and passing all **31 preflight gates**.
- **Data Stewardship:** Measures success through the accuracy of the local knowledge layer, targeting ≥ **5,000 verified place records** with at least **65% verified within the last 12 months**.
- **Regression Baseline:** Every session must successfully reproduce a canonical query (e.g., "What is the capital of WV?") with a **consensus score ≥ 0.95** and full judge validation.

Barriers to Entry

MountainShares will establish several key barriers to entry to protect its unique position as a community-rooted, non-extractive economic engine in Appalachian communities. Its success will be difficult for larger companies or new startups to copy because it is built on a foundation of local trust, proprietary place-based intelligence, and specialized protections for the region's most vulnerable residents.

1. Deep Community Integration and Earned Loyalty

The system is built on a "Long Game" of civic contribution where rank and governance "voice" are earned exclusively through documented hours of community work, not through financial stake. This creates a deeply rooted human layer of **Community Champions**, **Captains**, and **Elders** who serve as the primary onboarding and verification force. Because these roles are earned through multi-year commitments to the "Appalachian Tacet"—the lived experience and local knowledge of the region—an outside competitor cannot simply "buy" this community infrastructure.

2. First-Mover Advantage and Institutional Momentum

MountainShares is the first blockchain-based mutual-credit and rewards system focused specifically on Appalachian West Virginia, already operating on the Arbitrum One mainnet.

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It has secured strategic partnerships through the Corridor Partner Community Governance Agreement, which allows municipal and federal entities (such as the National Park Service in Thurmond) to host ALLIS mesh nodes at no direct financial cost. These physical and legal "anchors" in historic gateway communities create a strong local ecosystem that new entrants would find difficult to penetrate.

3. Proprietary "Intelligence with a ZIP Code"

Unlike generic AI platforms, **Ms. Jarvis** provides "Intelligence with a ZIP code," with reasoning grounded in a **5.4-million-belief GeoBelief Information Model (GBIM)** and a 45 GB PostGIS spatial database containing over 540 West Virginia-specific tables. This proprietary knowledge base includes deterministic data on institutional landholders and community resources that are locally governed and verified. The system is architected to treat this locally-governed data as authoritative, correcting for the "hallucinations" common in global language models.

4. Cultural and Linguistic Integrity

MountainShares utilizes the **AAPCAppE corpus** to ensure that Ms. Jarvis respects Appalachian English morphosyntax as normative rather than erroneous. The system's ability to recognize and respond in an authentic **maternal Appalachian voice**—while catching "structural false positives" that standard safety filters might misidentify as abusive—builds a level of cultural trust that generic "placeless" models cannot replicate.

5. Specialized "Benefits-Sensitive" Safeguards

A major barrier to entry is the **Benefits-Sensitive Account (BSA)** architecture, specifically designed to protect residents receiving means-tested public assistance (SSI, SNAP, Medicaid). By implementing hard balance caps, earning throttles, and an "eligibility-gated" rather than "price-denominated" exchange, MountainShares solves the "Iron Cage" problem of public benefits. Most tech-first competitors lack the deep regional policy expertise required to ensure that participation does not disqualify residents from essential services.

6. Post-Quantum Security and Epistemic Accountability

To ensure the system remains resilient against future threats, MountainShares employs **ML-DSA-65 post-quantum cryptographic signatures** on all AI judge verdicts. This creates a non-repudiable, durable audit trail in **jarvis-memory:8056**, allowing anyone to verify what the system decided and why. We are not asking for trust; we are building evidence through an auditable "glassbox" architecture that prioritizes transparency and place-based accountability.

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Company

Ownership & Structure

MountainShares is structured as a community-benefit program legally operated under the umbrella of **Harmony for Hope, Inc. (H4H)**, a West Virginia **501(c)(3) nonprofit corporation** based in Mount Hope.

1. Ownership and Stakeholder Standing

As a 501(c)(3) nonprofit, MountainShares does not have "owners" in the traditional sense of a for-profit business; there are no shareholders, and the program is not a vehicle for distributing profits. However, the system recognizes a **Founder's Capital Account** that establishes the non-dilutable governance standing of its primary architect.

- **Harmony for Hope, Inc. (H4H):** The nonprofit organization is the official legal owner and operator of the MountainShares program name, branding, and governance materials.
- **Carrie Ann Kidd / Kidd's Technical Services (KTS):** As the lead architect and founder, Carrie Kidd has contributed **5,308 hours** of senior technical labor—valued at **$796,200**—as an in-kind capital contribution. This establishes a documented **equity stake** in the form of governance authority, a seat at negotiation tables, and a veto power over proposals that might dilute the program's commons principles.
- **The Founder's Trust:** Conversion proceeds from the founder's pre-launch earned hours are assigned to a **personal revocable living trust** (the Founder's Trust) rather than being treated as direct personal income, specifically to protect benefits eligibility and ensure long-term stewardship.

2. Legal Structure

MountainShares is officially registered as a **nonprofit community rewards and payment program**. It is governed by a dual-layered structure:

- **Nonprofit Umbrella:** H4H serves as the legal and regulatory "safety envelope," managing bank relationships, contracts, and compliance with federal and state laws.
- **MountainShares DAO:** A decentralized autonomous organization (DAO) provides a participatory governance layer where community members earn a "voice" (voting rights) through documented work rather than financial investment.

3. Rationale for This Structure

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The nonprofit/DAO hybrid structure was chosen to ensure that value and decision-making remain rooted in Appalachian communities:

- **Community Governance:** The core rule is **"one UEI = one vote,"** ensuring that influence is earned through contribution (EMS hours) rather than purchased with wealth.
- **Non-Extractive Wealth Building:** Unlike global platforms, this structure prevents value from "leaking" to distant shareholders; instead, 30% of all fee revenue is returned to the **Treasury Reserve** to back the community economy.
- **Protection of the Vulnerable:** The nonprofit structure facilitates the creation of **Benefits-Sensitive Accounts (BSA)**, which use balance caps and earning throttles to ensure residents on public assistance can participate without risking their essential services like SSI or SNAP.
- **Asset Ownership:** While H4H operates the program, the underlying **ALLIS/Ms. Jarvis platform** is owned by KTS and provided to the nonprofit under a non-exclusive, royalty-free license for community benefit.

Management Team

MountainShares is led by a founder deeply embedded in the Appalachian experience, supported by a dedicated network of community practitioners and a locally-rooted nonprofit organization.

Founder's Profile: Carrie Ann Kidd (Mamma Kidd)

As the **primary architect and founder** of MountainShares and the Ms. Jarvis system, Carrie Ann Kidd brings a rare synthesis of high-level technical expertise and lived rural experience.

- **Skills and Experience:** She is a **senior geospatial systems architect** with over 10 years of experience, possessing expert-level mastery in **PostGIS, microservices architecture, and AI orchestration**. As of March 2026, she has personally contributed over **5,308 hours** of senior technical labor—valued at nearly **$800,000**—to build the system's "civilizational stack" from the ground up.
- **Appalachian Grounding:** Unlike distant developers, she is embedded in the "Tacet" of West Virginia, working from a structurally compromised but centrally located building in **Mount Hope**. Her background as a **Medicaid Waiver (PALCO) caregiver** directly informed the system's "Benefits-Sensitive" safety protocols, allowing her to identify and correct design flaws that would have penalized intensive family caregiving.

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- **Community Leadership:** Before founding MountainShares, she led local initiatives including the **Mount Hope Historic Walking Trail** and regional arts programming, demonstrating a long-term commitment to Appalachian heritage.

Key Operations Support: Community Champions

The daily operation of the system's data integrity relies on a structured "red team" of local practitioners.

- **Crystal Colyer, Lead Validator:** A resident of Boone County, Colyer serves as a primary **"boots-on-the-ground" validator**. She manages the verification of food pantries and resource locations across multiple counties, ensuring that the system's data is "ground-truthed" by those who actually use the services.
- **Harmony for Hope (H4H):** This **501(c)(3) nonprofit** serves as the legal and administrative anchor. The H4H Board of Directors provides fiduciary oversight and maintains the regulatory "safety envelope" required to operate a community credit system.

Future Staffing and Prospective Employee Needs

As MountainShares scales from its current **Phase 0 (Pilot)** to **Phase 2 (Statewide)** and **Phase 3 (Premium Reserve)**, the team will require specialized talent in several key areas:

- **Regional Champions (Tier 3 Employees):** For Phase 2 expansion, MountainShares will need leaders with **multi-county governance experience** to manage regional data quality and coordinate local "quests" across the New River Gorge corridor.
- **Regulatory and Legal Specialists:** To move into statewide commerce, the team will need expertise in **Money Transmitter Licensing (MTL)** and **FinCEN compliance**. Prospective staff must be able to navigate complex West Virginia and federal financial laws while protecting participants from "Benefit Cliffs".
- **Geospatial and AI Engineers:** Future staffing will include technicians to maintain the **PostGIS spatial body** (currently 45 GB with 548+ tables) and refine the **22-model LLM ensemble** that powers Ms. Jarvis.
- **Logistics and Fulfillment Coordinators:** To support the **Stage 3 "Full Commerce"** marketplace, MountainShares will eventually need staff to manage shipping, returns, and dispute resolution for Appalachian artisan and agricultural products.
- **Benefits Counselors:** Specialized staff will be needed to provide individual guidance to **Benefits-Sensitive Account** holders, ensuring their participation remains a "covenant" that protects their essential assistance.

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Advisors

MountainShares and the Ms. Jarvis steward system are supported by a **Scheduled Red Team** and a network of technical and community advisors. These individuals provide the "wise counsel" and rigorous testing necessary to ensure the system remains accountable, secure, and grounded in the lived realities of Appalachian West Virginia.

Scheduled Red Team and Core Advisors

Carrie Ann Kidd (Founder & Primary Architect)

- **Background:** A senior geospatial systems architect with expert-level mastery in **PostGIS, microservices architecture, and AI orchestration**.
- **Role:** As the originator of the Quantarithmia framework, she has contributed over **5,300 hours** of senior technical labor to build the Ms. Jarvis "civilizational stack" from her base in Mount Hope, West Virginia.
- **Benefit:** Her embeddedness in the "Tacet"—the non-negotiable evidence of regional life—ensures the system is built on honest, place-bound evidence rather than abstract global models.

Dr. Anurag Srivastava (Technical Advisor, West Virginia University)

- **Background:** Professor and Associate Dean for Research at WVU, representing the **University Commons Node** partnership.
- **Role:** He provides technical oversight and research guidance, particularly in modeling **infrastructure stress** and grid resilience.
- **Benefit:** His expertise helps harden the system against security threats and ensures that the **ALLIS mesh intelligence nodes** remain stable under heavy local demands.

Taryn Mosser (State of West Virginia GIS Coordinator)

- **Background:** Serves as the state's coordinator for geographic information systems (GIS).
- **Role:** Provides expert guidance on the integration of state-scale spatial bodies, which currently include **95 GB of data and 742 tables** in the system's PostGIS forensic container.

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- **Benefit:** Her involvement ensures that the system's **"Intelligence with a ZIP code"** is grounded in authoritative, locally-governed West Virginia datasets, such as the E-911 statewide address layer and tax parcel data.

Crystal Coyler (Community Coordinator & Lead Validator)

- **Background:** A resident and practitioner from Boone County with deep knowledge of how local programs and benefits function on the ground.
- **Role:** She leads the **"ground-truthing"** efforts, physically verifying the accuracy, hours, and accessibility of resources like food pantries and medical clinics.
- **Benefit:** Her validation prevents the system from drifting into "placeless abstraction" by ensuring that recommendations for residents in crisis are based on **verified, real-world availability**.

Brandon Thompson (Starry Eyes Media)

- **Role:** [Information provided by user] Serves as a key red team member providing strategic media and narrative support.
- **Benefit:** His participation ensures that Ms. Jarvis's communication remains culturally resonant and accessible to the community, helping to translate complex technical and economic rules into the authentic voice of the region.

The Role of the Red Team

These advisors function as "conscious testers" during the **Stage 1 Red-Team Onboarding**. Their job is to identify vulnerabilities, probe for misreadings of Appalachian life, and surface failure modes in the system's economic and identity geometry before the stack is opened for wider public enrollment. Every finding and gate decision made during these tests is durably logged in **jarvis-memory:8056**, creating a non-repudiable audit trail for community governance.

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Financial Plan

Revenue

Revenue by Year

No revenue yet

Expenses & Costs

Expenses by Year

No expenses or costs yet

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Profitability

Net Profit (or Loss) by Year

No net profit yet

Use of Funds

MountainShares utilizes a combination of documented **in-kind founder capital** and targeted **federal and foundation grant funding** to build a community-owned economic and technical stack. These funds are essential for transitioning from a research pilot into a durable, statewide infrastructure that prevents "extractive leakage" from Appalachia.

Should MountainShares secure loans or significant investments, the funds will be allocated across the following critical areas:

1. Physical Infrastructure and ALLIS Mesh Nodes

A primary use of outside funding is the procurement and deployment of **ALLIS mesh intelligence nodes** (`MS.____.ALLIS`).

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- **Hardware Procurement:** The project has established a hardware **cost ceiling of $40,000** for a full heritage reference implementation cluster (such as the one in Mount Hope).
- **Node Components:** Funds will pay for **Primary Intelligence Nodes** (local-first AI hardware), **SKLink network infrastructure** (point-to-point wireless), and **Trailhead Heritage Kiosks**.
- **Expansion:** Investment allows the system to scale from a single building in Mount Hope to a **corridor-scale mesh** serving communities like Thurmond and Fayetteville, providing local connectivity where internet access is often a luxury.

2. Regulatory and Legal Infrastructure

Operating a community-governed rewards and payment system at scale carries significant "legal infrastructure" costs.

- **Licensing:** Funds will cover **Money Transmitter License (MTL)** application fees and the required **$300,000 surety bond**, which are prerequisites for Phase 2 statewide commerce.
- **Compliance:** Costs include **FinCEN Money Services Business (MSB) registration** and legal counsel for navigating West Virginia financial legislation (e.g., SB887).
- **Reserve Backing:** While not a "spend," grant proceeds can supplement the **Treasury Reserve** to help the system reach the 300% (Phase 2) and 500% (Phase 3) reserve thresholds required to unlock higher community buying power.

3. Future Staffing and Organizational Capacity

As MountainShares matures into the Stage 3 "Full Commerce" layer, additional funding will allow for the transition from a solo researcher to a regional team.

- **Regional Champions:** Funds will support hiring leaders to manage regional data quality and coordinate local "quests" across multiple counties [see previous conversation history; 344].
- **Counselors and Specialists:** Staffing needs include **Benefits Counselors** to protect Benefits-Sensitive Account holders and **Logistics Coordinators** to manage the fulfillment of Appalachian-made products in the Commons marketplace [see previous conversation history; 1254].

4. Supporting the Mission of Spatial Justice

By investing in these areas, MountainShares ensures that decision-making power remains with the **"ZIP code"** where the value is generated. The funds enable the system to:

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- **Monetize "Invisible" Labor:** Provide the backing needed to convert **Earned MountainShares (EMS)** into spendable value for caregivers and volunteers.
- **Retain Local Wealth:** Ensure that transaction fees and price premiums from the **West Virginia diaspora** are captured by the community treasury rather than leaking to global logistics platforms.

The **$796,200** of documented technical labor contributed by the founder serves as a vital **in-kind match**, significantly increasing the system's readiness for federal grants from the **Appalachian Regional Commission (ARC)** and **USDA Rural Development**.

Sources of Funds

MountainShares utilizes a hybrid funding model that combines a substantial **in-kind founder investment**, targeted **federal and foundation grants**, and a self-sustaining **closed-loop fee engine**. The system is explicitly designed to avoid extractive venture capital, ensuring that all generated value remains rooted in the Appalachian commons.

1. Founder's Technical Investment

The primary "seed" funding for MountainShares is the documented **Founder's Technical Investment** contributed by Carrie Ann Kidd through Kidd's Technical Services (KTS).

- **Contributed Capital:** As of March 13, 2026, the founder has invested **5,308 hours** of senior technical labor.
- **Valuation:** This labor is valued at **$796,200** (benchmarked at a fair market rate of $150/hour).
- **Strategic Role:** This is treated as **non-dilutable equity** rather than a donation, establishing the founder's governance authority and veto power to prevent the introduction of extractive external capital.
- **Grant Matching:** This nearly $800,000 investment serves as a critical **in-kind match** for grant applications, significantly reducing the financial risk for outside funders.

2. Grants and Institutional Support

MountainShares actively seeks funding from organizations dedicated to rural development, technology innovation, and regional resilience.

- **Targeted Sources:** The program is positioned for grants from the **Appalachian Regional Commission (ARC)**, **USDA Rural Development**, and the **Department of Energy**.

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- **Hardware Procurement:** Grant proceeds are the primary intended source for purchasing physical infrastructure, such as the **ALLIS mesh node clusters** (with a cost ceiling of **$40,000** for the Mount Hope implementation).
- **Academic Partnerships:** Collaborative research grants, such as those through **West Virginia University (WVU)**, provide additional avenues for funding technical oversight and resilience modeling.

3. Community-Generated Revenue (The Fee Engine)

As the system transitions into live use, it generates its own operational and reserve funds through a standardized fee split.

- **Transaction Fees:** Revenue is generated from a **2.85% load fee** (USD to M$), a **1.80% merchant fee**, and a **0.25% internal transfer fee**.
- **Revenue Allocation:** 30% of all fee revenue is allocated to **Harmony for Hope (H4H) Operations** for staff and administration, while another 30% flows directly into the **Treasury Reserve** to back the community economy.
- **The Appalachian Premium:** A major source of future funding is the **West Virginia diaspora** (out-migrants). By purchasing authentic Appalachian goods in USD via a storefront, the diaspora contributes a price premium that directly strengthens the local treasury reserve.

4. Bootstrapping and Regulatory Draws

To bridge the gap between initial development and full-scale commerce, MountainShares employs "internal bootstrapping" mechanisms.

- **Regulatory Compliance Reserve Draw:** During Phase 2 and Phase 3, the system is authorized to draw from its own **Treasury Reserve** to fund legally required infrastructure, such as **West Virginia Money Transmitter Licenses** (estimated at 30,000–40,000 for initial licensing and bonding).
- **Staged Rollout:** By focusing on a "Proof of Circulation" in Fayette County before expanding, the system ensures that growth never outpaces the health of the treasury.

5. Future Funding Timeline

- **October 2027:** Targeted milestone for hardware procurement and the completion of the full heritage node cluster in Fayette County, contingent on successful grant awards.

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- **November 2028:** Final project handoff and transition to fully self-sustained community operations.

Projected Statements

Projected Profit & Loss

	2026	2027	2028
Revenue	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Direct Costs	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Gross Profit	$0	$0	$0
Gross Margin	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**
Operating Expenses			
Total Operating Expenses	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Operating Income	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Interest Expense	$0	$0	$0
Depreciation and Amortization	$0	$0	$0
Gain or Loss from Sale of Assets	$0	$0	$0
Income Taxes	$0	$0	$0
Total Expenses	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Net Profit	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Net Profit Margin	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**

Projected Balance Sheet

	2026	2027	2028
Assets	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Current Assets	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Cash	$0	$0	$0

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	2026	2027	2028
Accounts Receivable	$0	$0	$0
Long-Term Assets	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Liabilities & Equity	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Liabilities	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Current Liabilities	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Accounts Payable	$0	$0	$0
Long-Term Liabilities	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Equity	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Retained Earnings	$0	$0	$0
Earnings	$0	$0	$0

Projected Cash Flow

	2026	2027	2028
Net Cash from Operations	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Net Profit	$0	$0	$0
Change in Accounts Receivable	$0	$0	$0
Change in Accounts Payable	$0	$0	$0
Net Cash from Investing	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Net Cash from Financing	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Cash at Beginning of Period	$0	$0	$0
Net Change in Cash	$0	$0	$0
Cash at End of Period	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**

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Appendix

Projected Profit & Loss (2026)

	Jan '26	Feb '26	Mar '26	Apr '26	May '26	June '26	July '26	Aug '26	Sept '26	Oct '26	Nov '26	Dec '26	2026
Gross Profit	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Gross Margin	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Operating Expenses	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Operating Income	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Total Expenses	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Net Profit	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Net Profit Margin	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**

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Projected Profit & Loss (2027)

	Jan '27	Feb '27	Mar '27	Apr '27	May '27	June '27	July '27	Aug '27	Sept '27	Oct '27	Nov '27	Dec '27	2027
Gross Profit	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Gross Margin	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Operating Expenses	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Operating Income	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Total Expenses	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Net Profit	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Net Profit Margin	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**	**0%**

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Projected Profit & Loss (2028)

	2028
Gross Profit	$0
Gross Margin	0%
Operating Expenses	**$0**
Operating Income	**$0**
Total Expenses	$0
Net Profit	$0
Net Profit Margin	**0%**

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Projected Balance Sheet (2026)

	Jan '26	Feb '26	Mar '26	Apr '26	May '26	June '26	July '26	Aug '26	Sept '26	Oct '26	Nov '26	Dec '26	2026
Assets	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Current Assets	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Cash	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Accounts Receivable	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Long-Term Assets	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Liabilities & Equity	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Liabilities	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Current Liabilities	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Accounts Payable	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Long-Term Liabilities	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Equity	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Retained Earnings	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Earnings	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0

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Projected Balance Sheet (2027)

	Jan '27	Feb '27	Mar '27	Apr '27	May '27	June '27	July '27	Aug '27	Sept '27	Oct '27	Nov '27	Dec '27	2027
Assets	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Current Assets	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Cash	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Accounts Receivable	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Long-Term Assets	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Liabilities & Equity	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Liabilities	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Current Liabilities	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Accounts Payable	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Long-Term Liabilities	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Equity	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Retained Earnings	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Earnings	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0

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Projected Balance Sheet (2028)

	2028
Assets	**$0**
Current Assets	**$0**
Cash	$0
Accounts Receivable	$0
Long-Term Assets	**$0**
Liabilities & Equity	**$0**
Liabilities	**$0**
Current Liabilities	**$0**
Accounts Payable	$0
Long-Term Liabilities	**$0**
Equity	**$0**
Retained Earnings	$0
Earnings	$0

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Projected Cash Flow (2026)

	Jan '26	Feb '26	Mar '26	Apr '26	May '26	June '26	July '26	Aug '26	Sept '26	Oct '26	Nov '26	Dec '26	2026
Net Cash from Operations	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Net Profit	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Change in Accounts Receivable	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Change in Accounts Payable	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Net Cash from Investing	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Net Cash from Financing	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Cash at Beginning of Period	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Net Change in Cash	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Cash at End of Period	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**

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Projected Cash Flow (2027)

	Jan '27	Feb '27	Mar '27	Apr '27	May '27	June '27	July '27	Aug '27	Sept '27	Oct '27	Nov '27	Dec '27	2027
Net Cash from Operations	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Net Profit	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Change in Accounts Receivable	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Change in Accounts Payable	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Net Cash from Investing	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Net Cash from Financing	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**
Cash at Beginning of Period	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Net Change in Cash	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0	$0
Cash at End of Period	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**	**$0**

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Projected Cash Flow (2028)

	2028
Net Cash from Operations	**$0**
Net Profit	$0
Change in Accounts Receivable	$0
Change in Accounts Payable	$0
Net Cash from Investing	**$0**
Net Cash from Financing	**$0**
Cash at Beginning of Period	$0
Net Change in Cash	$0
Cash at End of Period	**$0**

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